

LOG FILE ANALYSIS – EASY STEP GUIDE

Step 1: Go to Log Directory

```
cd /var/log  
ls
```

This shows all system logs like apache2, journal, wtmp, btmp.

Step 2: Check Successful Logins

```
last
```

Shows login history of users.

Step 3: Check System Logs

```
journalctl | less
```

View all system logs.

Step 4: Find Failed Login Attempts

```
journalctl | grep 'Failed'
```

Shows failed login attempts.

Step 5: Check SSH Activity

```
journalctl | grep ssh
```

Shows SSH login activity.

Step 6: Detect Errors

```
journalctl | grep -i error
```

Find system errors.

Step 7: Apache Log Analysis

```
cd /var/log/apache2  
sudo less access.log
```

View web requests.

Step 8: Find Suspicious Requests

```
grep '404' /var/log/apache2/access.log
```

Shows failed requests (possible attacks).

Step 9: Install lastb (IMPORTANT FIX)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install util-linux
```

lastb is not a package, it comes from util-linux.

Step 10: Check Failed Logins using lastb

```
sudo lastb
```

Shows failed login attempts from /var/log/btmp.

Step 11: Identify Suspicious IP

```
journalctl | grep 'Failed password' | awk '{print $11}' | sort | uniq -c | sort -nr
```

Find IP with many attempts.

Step 12: Real-Time Monitoring

```
sudo journalctl -f
```

Monitor logs live.

Conclusion

Repeated failed logins or unknown IPs indicate possible brute force attack.